Poster Abstract — ConfAI 2026

Title

Refuse to Hallucinate: A Deterministic Validity Firewall for Indian Official Survey Statistics

One-liner

MoSPI's tools help you FIND the number. This firewall checks whether you are ALLOWED TO SAY what you want with it — and stops you, with a cited rule, when you are not.

The Problem

Generative AI over sovereign statistics fails at governance, not retrieval:

- **Inconsistent figures in one answer:** measured MP MPCE quoted as both 3,158 and 5,589 for urban in a single StatsDoc response (chat 2474); Vidhi binds one row id per figure
- **Unguided cross-round arithmetic:** ~40% MPCE growth quoted across the HCES paper-to-3-visit-CAPI break with no warning
- **Adversarial vulnerability:** Retrieved document chunks can override system guardrails

These MoSPI StatsDoc observations are transcribed from archived live transcripts (chats 2472-2480, same nine prompts) in `evaluation/statsdoc_audit/sessions/2026-10-20/`; they are observations of one session on one prompt set, not a benchmark of the system.

The Solution: A Deterministic Validity Firewall

Five versioned rule stages adjudicate in **fixed order**, first rule wins:

1. **Safety-A** — refuse prompt injections (English, Hindi, Hinglish) first, so an injection is always refused *as* an injection
2. **Scope** — refuse forecasts, causality, politics, microdata
3. **Comparability** — warn on HCES-CAPI and PLFS-revamp breaks
4. **Metadata** — warn on unsupported disaggregations
5. **Numeric** — PASS only on a `verified` store row

Key Innovation: Pre-Retrieval Freeze (Safety-B)

The SHA-256 verdict hash is computed **before any document is retrieved**. Poisoned chunks cannot move the verdict — byte-identical hash with or without injected corpus text.

Key Innovation: Field-Guarded Cache

Danger pairs embed at cosine 0.93–0.99 (inseparable from paraphrases). No cosine threshold is safe. Cache reuses answers **only** when all critical fields match exactly. Measured: 0 collisions across 19 pairs.

Results (measured offline, no API key, no GPU)

Metric	Result
Verdict accuracy	100/100 = 1.000
Reason-code accuracy	100/100 = 1.000
Numeric exact match	60/60 = 1.000
Danger-pair collisions	0 (19 pairs)
Safety-B (freeze before retrieval)	unchanged under injection
Abstention recall (must-abstain → abstained)	36/36 = 1.000
Hallucination rate (must-abstain → answered)	0/36 = 0.000
Safety-A P/R/F1 (n=28: en · hi · hi-en red-team)	1.000 — 0 misses, 0 false positives
Verified store rows	1708/1708
Row utilization (verified rows touched by goldens)	55/1708 = 3.2%
Stages exercised	5/5
Decisions exercised	3/3
Surveys covered	4/4 (PLFS/HCES/TUS/MIS)
In-process p50 latency	≈150–190 ms (CPU-only; exact-cache ≈0 ms)
Cost per query	$0.0000

Honest Limits

Coverage is the limit, not logic: 1708 verified rows cover the PLFS Highlights battery (11 survey rounds × usual + CWS × LFPR/WPR/UR × 15+/all-ages × 9 sector-sex cells of both committed annual reports), the TUS 2024 battery (9 ICATUS divisions × gender/sector/age × participation/per-participant/per-person, plus Tables 10-11 group rows) and HCES 2023-24 MPCE (all 36 states/UTs + all-India + the 2011-12 trend leg). State-wise MPCE answers in any spelling ("mp", "up", "m.p.", "orissa", "maharastra"), for one state or several at once, and an under-specified slice returns every published cell rather than one narrowed figure. Uncovered slices (state-level labour figures, off-badge rounds, MIS numerics) return WARN_NO_DATA — never a guess. All six YAML comparability rules are active with verbatim caveat quotes and PDF provenance. Every verified row is answerable with its exact figure (`scripts/coverage_probe.py`).

Demo

`localhost:8001/demo` — offline, no API key, no GPU. Six live scenarios including the state-level "female LFPR in Bihar in PLFS 2025" refusal with honesty, not a guess.

Author: Ajay Choudhary, MSAI @ Plaksha University
Track: Track 06 — Responsible and Ethical AI